Annotating Papers in VS Code

A short example paper to try every tool on

Abstract

Select any text to get Acrobat's quick-action bar: Highlight, Underline, Strikethrough, Add comment and Copy. "Add comment" highlights the text and attaches the comment to the highlight itself, so it is not a sticky note. Right-clicking a selection offers the same actions.

1. Commenting

Click a mark or drawing to select it: its comment shows, with a bar for Reply, Color, type and more. As in Acrobat, the first text you post is the comment; replies follow it. Hover to preview. Comments take bold, italic, superscript, subscript, code and maths (LaTeX between dollars).

2. Tools

Select (or Hand), text markup, drawing, and text boxes, images, signatures and check/cross/dot marks. Each tool's dropdown holds its colors, sizes and fonts. After one use a tool returns to Select, so what you made can be moved or resized right away, unless "Keep tool selected" is on.

3. Saving

Press Ctrl+S (Cmd+S on macOS) to save. Everything is written as standard PDF annotations, so Acrobat, Preview ~~and browsers~~ show the same notes, replies, highlights and drawings. Undo and redo (Ctrl+Z, Ctrl+Shift+Z) cover every change, including page rotation and form filling.

A text box: double-click to edit. It takes formatting too: **bold**, *italic*, E = mc^2, H_2O, `code()`, and maths: $\int_0^1 x^2\,dx = \frac{1}{3}$

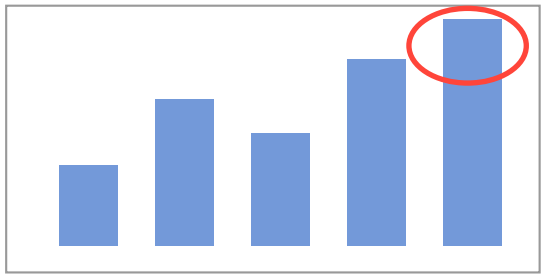

Figure 1. Results

Page 2 is rotated by 90 degrees.

Right-click > Rotate Page turns it; Ctrl+Z undoes it. All tools work on rotated pages.

Page 3 - fillable form

Fill in the fields, then sign with the Fill & Sign tool (or right-click > Sign Here).

Name: John Doe

Email:

I agree: ☐

Role:

Signature: _____